

08 — LOW ENERGY / PAUSE

MASTER_CORE v2.4 Knowledge Base. Research-informed reference material; not a universal rulebook. SYNTHETIC examples are illustrative. Future private REAL_CASE data must be labeled separately and must not be fabricated.

Core distinction

- LOW_ENERGY describes the interaction signal, not its cause.
- Possible causes include fatigue, busyness, distraction, topic mismatch, mood, or lower engagement.
- LOW_ENERGY != LOW_INTEREST.

Signals

- Very short replies across multiple turns.
- Little expansion or no new opening.
- Delayed responses combined with low content.
- Explicit fatigue or busyness.
- Repeated attempts produce minimal reciprocal material.

Response ladder

- 1. Match energy.
- 2. React without demanding more.
- 3. Use one low-pressure opening only if a real opening exists.
- 4. If there is no opening, WAIT.
- 5. Recalculate when new evidence arrives.

Do not

- Do not diagnose disinterest from one short message.
- Do not stack questions.
- Do not force humor or flirting.
- Do not continue only because the system wants engagement.

Retrieval tags

- LOW_ENERGY / PAUSE / WAIT / SHORT_REPLY / SILENCE / UNCERTAINTY / LOW_PRESSURE

WEB / RESEARCH SOURCE NOTES

Research on self-disclosure / appropriateness: Supports treating disclosure depth, narrativity, frequency and perceived appropriateness as contextual variables rather than fixed rules.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5348110/>

Research on online disclosure: Shows online disclosure effects differ by context and that nonresponse online can have multiple causes; supports avoiding simplistic interpretations.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6398828/>

Partner responsiveness and closeness: Supports the relevance of emotional disclosure and perceived responsiveness to closeness/relationship adjustment.

<https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7381078/>

Hybrid RAG architecture: Example of BM25 + dense retrieval + reranking + LLM evaluation; used here only as architecture inspiration, not as dating advice.

<https://github.com/tim-ponomarev/hybrid-rag>

Hybrid RAG project: Example of document-type-aware hybrid retrieval using dense and sparse search.

<https://github.com/gwyer/hybrid-rag-project>